

# Attached

The New Science of Adult Attachment  
and How It Can Help You Find—  
and Keep—Love



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FIGURE 1

## Attachment Style Questionnaire

Check the small box next to each statement that is TRUE for you.  
(If the answer is untrue, *don't* mark the item at all.)

|                                                                                                          | TRUE                     |                                     |                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                                          | A                        | B                                   | C                        |
| I often worry that my partner will stop loving me.                                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| I find it easy to be affectionate with my partner.                                                       |                          | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                          |
| I fear that once someone gets to know the real me, they won't like who I am.                             | <input type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| I find that I bounce back quickly after a breakup. It's weird how I can just put someone out of my mind. |                          |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| When I'm not involved in a relationship, I feel somewhat anxious and incomplete.                         | <input type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| I find it difficult to emotionally support my partner when they are feeling down.                        |                          |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| When my partner is away, I'm afraid that they might become interested in someone else.                   | <input type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |

|                                                                                     | TRUE                                |                                     |                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                     | A                                   | B                                   | C                        |
| I feel comfortable depending on romantic partners.                                  |                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                          |
| My independence is more important to me than my relationships.                      |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I prefer not to share my innermost feelings with my partner.                        |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| When I show my partner how I feel, I'm afraid they will not feel the same about me. | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                                     |                          |
| I am generally satisfied with my romantic relationships.                            |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                          |
| I don't feel the need to act out much in my romantic relationships.                 |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                          |
| I think about my relationships a lot.                                               | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| I find it difficult to depend on romantic partners.                                 |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I tend to get very quickly attached to a romantic partner.                          | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| I have little difficulty expressing my needs and wants to my partner.               |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                          |
| I sometimes feel angry or annoyed with my partner without knowing why.              |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I am very sensitive to my partner's moods.                                          | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| I believe most people are essentially honest and dependable.                        |                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                          |
| I prefer casual sex with uncommitted partners to intimate sex with one person.      |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I'm comfortable sharing my personal thoughts and feelings with my partner.          |                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                          |

|                                                                                                                                                      | TRUE                                |                                     |                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                      | A                                   | B                                   | C                        |
| I worry that if my partner leaves me I might never find someone else.                                                                                | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                                     |                          |
| It makes me nervous when my partner gets too close.                                                                                                  |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| During a conflict, I tend to impulsively do or say things I later regret, rather than be able to reason about things.                                | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| An argument with my partner doesn't usually cause me to question our entire relationship.                                                            |                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                          |
| My partners often want me to be more intimate than I feel comfortable being.                                                                         |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I worry that I'm not attractive enough.                                                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                                     |                          |
| Sometimes people see me as boring because I create little drama in relationships.                                                                    |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                          |
| I miss my partner when we're apart, but then when we're together I feel the need to escape.                                                          |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| When I disagree with someone, I feel comfortable expressing my opinions.                                                                             |                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                          |
| I hate feeling that other people depend on me.                                                                                                       |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| If I notice that someone I'm interested in is checking out other people, I don't let it faze me. I might feel a pang of jealousy, but it's fleeting. |                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                          |
| If I notice that someone I'm interested in is checking out other people, I feel relieved—it means they're not looking to make things exclusive.      |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| If I notice that someone I'm interested in is checking out other people, it makes me feel depressed.                                                 | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                                     |                          |
| If someone I've been dating begins to act cold and distant, I may wonder what's happened, but I'll know it's probably not about me.                  |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                          |

|                                                                                                                                   | TRUE                                |                                     |                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                   | A                                   | B                                   | C                        |
| If someone I've been dating begins to act cold and distant, I'll probably be indifferent; I might even be relieved.               |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| If someone I've been dating begins to act cold and distant, I'll worry that I've done something wrong.                            | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| If my partner was to break up with me, I'd try my best to show them what they're missing (a little jealousy can't hurt).          | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                                     |                          |
| If someone I've been dating for several months tells me they want to stop seeing me, I'd feel hurt at first, but I'd get over it. |                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |                          |
| Sometimes when I get what I want in a relationship, I'm not sure what I want anymore.                                             |                                     |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I won't have much of a problem staying in touch with my ex (strictly platonic)—after all, we have a lot in common.                |                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                          |

\*Adapted from Fraley, Waller, and Brennan's (2000) ECR-R Questionnaire.

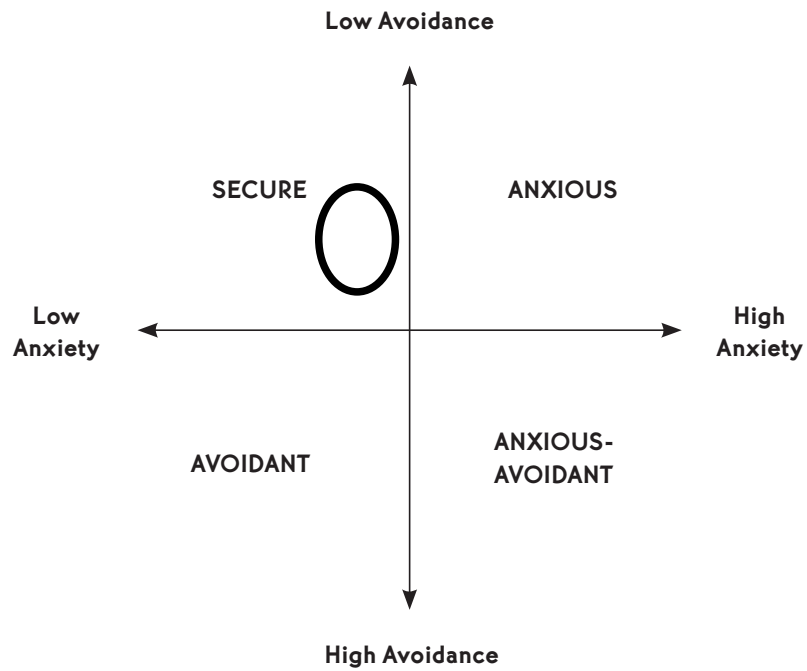
Add up all your checked boxes in column A: 6

Add up all your checked boxes in column B: 8

Add up all your checked boxes in column C: 1

FIGURE 2

## The Two Attachment Dimensions



*(Based on Brennan, Clark, and Shaver's Two Attachment Dimension Scale)*

FIGURE 3

## Determining Your Partner's Attachment Style

### QUESTIONNAIRE: DETERMINING YOUR PARTNER'S ATTACHMENT STYLE

Following is a questionnaire designed to help you establish your partner's or date's attachment style.

The questionnaire is divided into three groups. Each describes certain characteristics illustrated with a few examples. *Note that if the characteristic in general is true of your partner, you should score it as true. It is also enough that only one example, and not all, be true of your partner to mark it as true.* After reading each characteristic, decide on the basis of all your interactions and conversations with your partner or date whether it is true of them. The truer it is, the higher you should score, based on the following scale:

#### SCORING KEY

1. Very *untrue* of them
2. Moderately true of them
3. Very *true* of them

## GROUP A

| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>1. Sends mixed signals.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Seems distant and aloof yet vulnerable at the same time (which you find irresistible).</li> <li>• Sometimes calls a lot and other times not at all.</li> <li>• Says something intimate like “When we move in together . . .”; but later acts as though you don’t have a future as a couple.</li> </ul>                           |
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>2. Values their independence greatly</b>—looks down on dependency and “neediness.”</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “I need a lot of space.”</li> <li>• “My work takes up so much of my time there’s no room for anyone serious in my life right now.”</li> <li>• “I could never be with someone who isn’t completely self-sufficient.”</li> </ul>                                            |
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>3. Devalues you</b> (or previous partners)—even if only jokingly.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Jokes about how lousy you are at reading maps or how “cute” it is that you’re roly-poly.</li> <li>• Describes someone they were once really interested in but after a couple of dates became turned off because of some physical feature.</li> <li>• Cheated on a past partner.</li> </ul> |



| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>4. Uses distancing strategies—emotional or physical.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Had a previous partner for six years, but they lived in separate households.</li> <li>• Prefers to go to sleep at home, to use separate blankets, or to sleep in a separate bed.</li> <li>• Prefers taking vacations alone.</li> <li>• Plans are left unclear—when you will meet again, when they will move in.</li> <li>• Stays a stride ahead of you when you’re walking together.</li> </ul> |
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>5. Emphasizes boundaries in the relationship.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Makes you feel that “These are MY friends [or family]—keep out!”</li> <li>• Doesn’t want to invite you to their place, prefers to spend time at yours.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>6. Has an unrealistically romantic view of how a relationship should be.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Talks longingly about finding that one perfect person one day.</li> <li>• Idealizes a past relationship but is vague about what went wrong.</li> <li>• “I don’t know if I’ll ever be able to feel again the way I did about my ex.”</li> </ul>                                                                                                                              |
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>7. Mistrustful—fears being taken advantage of by partner.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Is sure that dates are out to “hitch” them into marriage.</li> <li>• Fears partner will take financial advantage of them.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>8. Has rigid view of relationships and uncompromising rules</b> (which you must comply with).</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Has a strong preference for a certain “type” of partner: very good-looking or very thin or blond, for example.</li> <li>• Is certain it’s best to live in separate houses or not to get married.</li> <li>• Makes sweeping statements like “All partners want such-and-such” or “After you get married or move in together, they change on you.”</li> <li>• Doesn’t like talking on the phone even if this is your main way to connect.</li> </ul> |
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>9. During a disagreement, needs to get away or “explodes.”</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• “You know what, forget it, I don’t want to talk about it.”</li> <li>• Gets up and walks out in fury.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>10. Doesn’t make their intentions clear—leaves you guessing as to their feelings.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Stays with you for a long time but doesn’t say “I love you.”</li> <li>• Talks about going abroad for a year without mentioning where that leaves the two of you.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 1 2 3 | <p><b>11. Has difficulty talking about what’s going on between you.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Makes you feel uncomfortable for asking where the relationship is headed.</li> <li>• When you say something is bothering you, responds “I’m sorry . . .” without further clarification.</li> <li>• Certain topics are off-limits.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

(Add the scores for questions 1–11.)

Group A Total Score: \_\_\_\_\_

## GROUP B

| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <b>1. Reliable and consistent.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Phones when they say they'll phone.</li> <li>• Makes plans in advance and follows through. If can't make it, gives advance notice, apologizes, and specifies an alternative plan.</li> <li>• Doesn't go back on promises. If they can't keep promise—explains!</li> </ul>                                                                                                 |
| 1 2 3 | <b>2. Makes decisions with you</b> (not unilaterally). <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Discusses plans, doesn't like to decide without hearing your opinion first.</li> <li>• Makes plans that take your preferences into account. Doesn't assume they know best.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1 2 3 | <b>3. Flexible view of relationships.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Isn't looking for a particular type of partner; e.g., a certain age or appearance.</li> <li>• Is open to different arrangements—like moving in together, or joint versus separate bank accounts.</li> <li>• Doesn't make sweeping statements like "All partners want such-and-such" or "After you get married or move in together, they change on you."</li> </ul> |
| 1 2 3 | <b>4. Communicates relationship issues well.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Makes you feel comfortable for asking about where the relationship stands or how they see your future together (even if the answer isn't to your liking).</li> <li>• Tells you if something is bothering them; doesn't act out or expect you to guess.</li> </ul>                                                                                           |

| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <b>5. Can reach compromise during arguments.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Does their best to understand what is <i>really</i> bothering you and to address that issue.</li> <li>When you have a misunderstanding, is not too busy proving they're right to solve the problem.</li> </ul>                                                    |
| 1 2 3 | <b>6. Not afraid of commitment or dependency.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Doesn't worry that you are trying to impinge on their territory or freedom.</li> <li>Isn't afraid you or other partners are trying to trap them into marriage, get their money, etc.</li> </ul>                                                                  |
| 1 2 3 | <b>7. Doesn't view relationship as hard work.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Doesn't talk about how much compromise and effort a relationship takes.</li> <li>Is open to starting a new relationship even when circumstances aren't ideal (e.g., when work/studies take up much time).</li> </ul>                                             |
| 1 2 3 | <b>8. Closeness creates further closeness</b> (rather than distancing). <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>After an emotional or revealing conversation, reassures you and is there for you. Doesn't suddenly get cold feet!</li> <li>After sleeping together, tells you how much you mean to them (not <i>just</i> how good the sex was).</li> </ul> |
| 1 2 3 | <b>9. Introduces friends and family early on.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Wants to make you part of their circle of friends. Might not initiate your meeting their family, but if you ask to meet them or invite your partner to meet yours, will be happy to.</li> </ul>                                                                  |
| 1 2 3 | <b>10. Naturally expresses feelings for you.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Usually tells you early on how they feel about you.</li> <li>Uses those three words "I love you" generously.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                           |

| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <b>11. Doesn't play games.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Doesn't leave you guessing or try to make you feel jealous.</li> <li>Doesn't make calculations such as "I already called twice, now it's your turn" or "You waited an entire day to get back to me, now I'll wait a day too."</li> </ul> |

(Add the scores for questions 1–11.)

Group B Total Score: \_\_\_\_\_

### GROUP C

| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <b>1. Wants a lot of closeness in the relationship.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Agrees to go on joint vacations, move in together, or spend all your time together early in relationship (although might not initiate it).</li> <li>Likes a great deal of physical contact (holding hands, caressing, kissing).</li> </ul>                                                              |
| 1 2 3 | <b>2. Expresses insecurities—worries about rejection.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Asks a lot of questions about your past partners to assess where they stand in comparison.</li> <li>Tries to see whether you still have feelings for your ex.</li> <li>Tries hard to please you.</li> <li>Fears that you'll stop having feelings toward them or will lose sexual interest.</li> </ul> |

| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <b>3. Unhappy when not in a relationship.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>You can sense that they are desperate to find someone even if they don't say so.</li> <li>Sometimes the date feels like an interview for the "future partner" slot.</li> </ul>                                                                                     |
| 1 2 3 | <b>4. Plays games to keep your attention/interest.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Acts distant and uninterested if you haven't called for a few days.</li> <li>Pretends to be unavailable or busy.</li> <li>Tries to manipulate certain situations to make you more available/interested in them.</li> </ul>                                |
| 1 2 3 | <b>5. Has difficulty explaining what's bothering them. Expects you to guess.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Expects you to pick up from subtle cues that they're upset. (If this doesn't work, acts out.)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                        |
| 1 2 3 | <b>6. Acts out—instead of trying to resolve the problem between you.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Threatens to leave during an argument (but later changes their mind).</li> <li>Doesn't express their needs but eventually acts upset about an accumulation of hurts.</li> </ul>                                                         |
| 1 2 3 | <b>7. Has a hard time <i>not</i> making things about themselves in the relationship.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>If you have to work late when they have a party, interprets it as "You don't want to meet my friends."</li> <li>If you come home tired and don't want to talk, interprets it as "You don't love me anymore."</li> </ul> |

| Score | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 2 3 | <b>8. Lets you set the tone of the relationship so as not to get hurt.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>You call, they call; you say you have feelings, they say they have feelings for you (at least at first). Doesn't want to take chances.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                         |
| 1 2 3 | <b>9. Is preoccupied with the relationship.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>At the end of a date, you go home to sleep. They go home to hash out every detail with friends.</li> <li>When you're not together, calls or texts a lot <i>or</i> doesn't call at all and waits for you to call (as a defensive act).</li> <li>You can tell that they think about the relationship a lot.</li> </ul> |
| 1 2 3 | <b>10. Fears that small acts will ruin the relationship; believes they must work hard to keep your interest.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Says things like "I called you so many times today, I'm afraid you'll get tired of me" or "I really didn't present myself very well to your family, and now your family will hate me."</li> </ul>                                                   |
| 1 2 3 | <b>11. Suspicious that you may be unfaithful.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Gets access to your password and checks your e-mail account.</li> <li>Hypervigilant about your whereabouts.</li> <li>Goes through your belongings looking for evidence.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                 |

(Add the scores for questions 1–11.)

Group C Total Score: \_\_\_\_\_

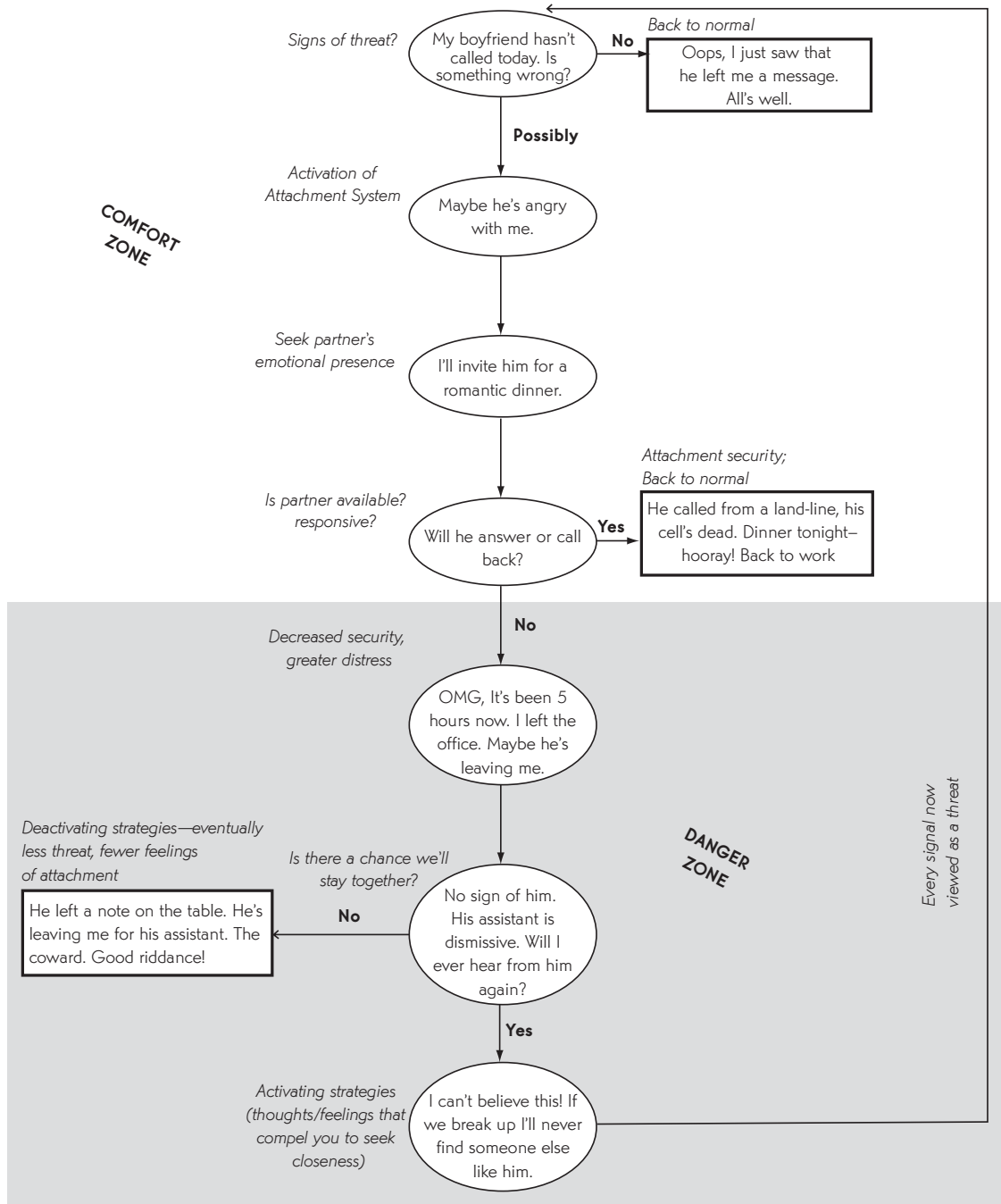
#### SCORING KEY

- 11–17: Very low. Your partner definitely doesn't have this attachment style.
- 18–22: Moderate. Your partner shows a tendency toward this attachment style.
- 23–33: High. Your partner definitely has this attachment style.

FIGURE 4

# The Attachment System

## FINDING YOUR WAY TO THE COMFORT ZONE



(Based on Shaver and Mikulincer's 2002 integrative model)



FIGURE 5

## The Nuts and Bolts of the Anxious-Avoidant Trap

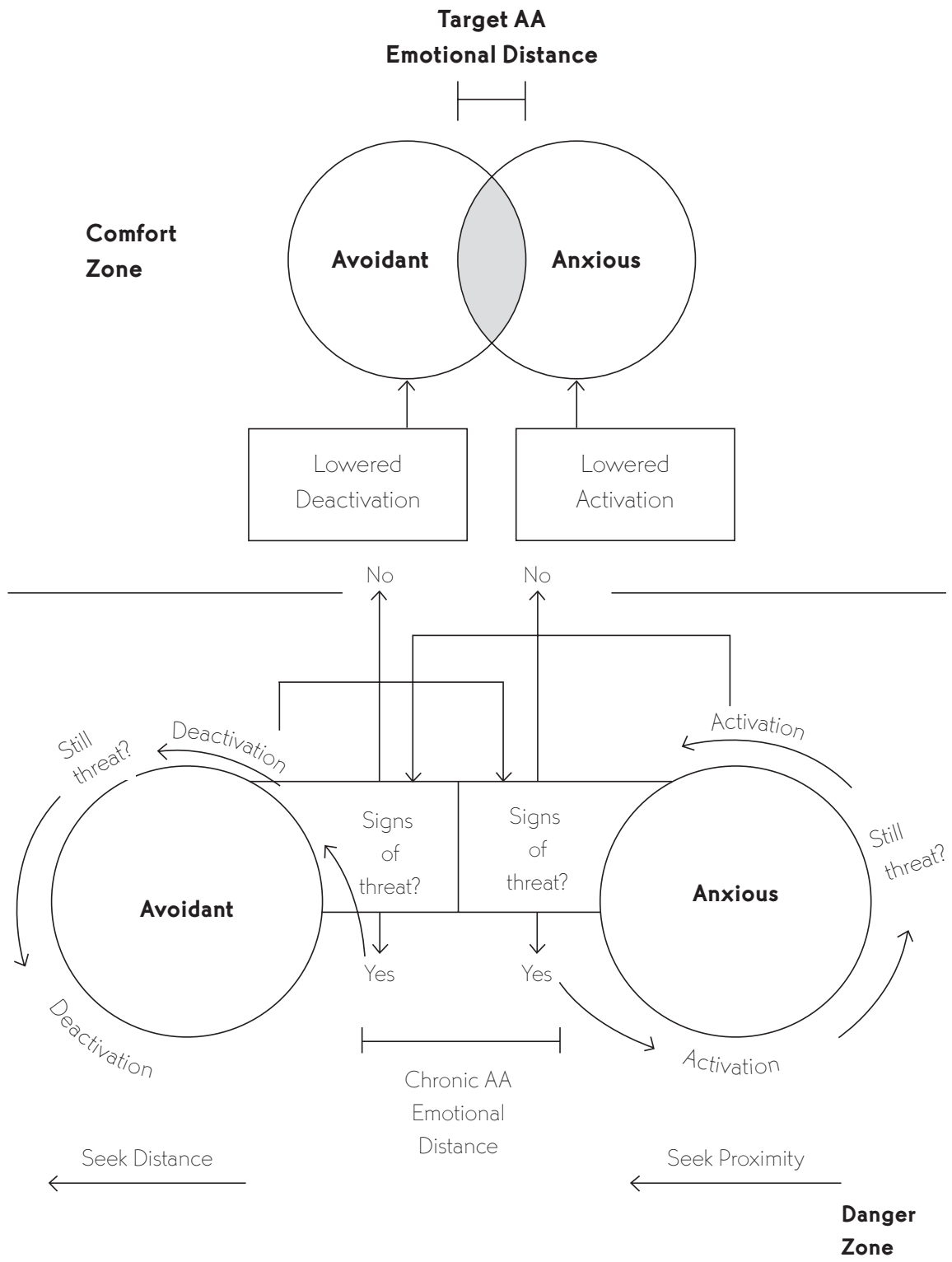


FIGURE 6

## Relationship Inventory

### RELATIONSHIP INVENTORY

| 1. Name of partner | 2. What is/was the relationship like? What recurrent patterns can you recall? | 3. Situation that triggered activation or deactivation of attachment system | 4. My reaction (thoughts, feelings, actions) | 5. Insecure attachment working models and principles | 6. How I lose out by succumbing to these working models/ principles | 7. Identify a secure role model who is relevant to this situation <i>and</i> secure principles to adopt. How are they relevant? |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|                    |                                                                               |                                                                             |                                              |                                                      |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |